

The Recasting of the Latin American Right

Polarization and Conservative Reactions

Edited by André Borges, Ryan Lloyd,
and Gabriel Vommaro



The Recasting of the Latin American Right

This book analyzes the transformation of the political right in Latin America in response to the strengthening of left-wing parties and movements throughout the region. While Latin America's post-2000 left has been widely studied, little is known about right-wing political formations during and after that time. There is a paucity of research on recent phenomena associated with the reorganization of the right: the polarization of Latin American electorates and elites; the rebranding of preexisting conservative parties; the creation of new right-wing parties; and the rise of the radical right. This volume provides a comprehensive account of the strategies used by the political right since 2000. It analyzes both the supply side (parties, movements, and personalist vehicles) and the demand side (voters and public opinion) to provide a description and explanation of how the right has recast itself as a new political force across the entire region of Latin America.

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model. However, when
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In this chapter, we also had on the political system right coalition, *Chile Var* plebiscite on a new constitution results in the election to

On the one hand, the ties to return to more centrist programmatic identities and favorability to redistributional defense of the dogma (and conservatism).

On the other hand, it is in presidential elections, not in the off ballot. To the surprise of the radical-right *Partido Republicano*, going on to compete in the second round. Further, the *Kast* in the runoff. We are turning point in the dynasty, since the emergence of these.

This chapter addresses the strategy and the ideas of the center-right coalition *Christians and Democrats* (Katz and Mair, 1998) in the context of transformation (Katz and Mair, 1998; Katz et al., 1988) of the party *Union Democristiana* (UDI), led it to follow

The concept originates from *Gattopardismo* is best illustrated by the fact that he wants things to stay the same. The social unrest refers to a social movement that began in October 2019, and then spread to other parts of the country. A coalition comprising three political parties, including the *Nacional* (RN), created in 1983, which is considered the main government to facilitate the process of political transition in the country (Napoli), founded in 2015, which is the main political party in the country.

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by modifying only superficial aspects of reality while creating expectations for more holistic change.¹ Indeed, the traditional right-wing parties moved toward the center to the extent that they did not threaten the pillars of the neoliberal model. However, when centrist and left-wing parties aimed to significantly reform the institutional core, the traditional right did react, and moved further to the right on the ideological continuum.

In this chapter, we also look at the consequences that the 2019 social unrest² had on the political system, especially on the parties of the then-ruling center-right coalition, *Chile Vamos*.³ While a sense of catastrophe set in after the 2020 plebiscite on a new constitution, it took a turn for the worse after the crushing results in the election to nominate the constituents who would draft the proposal.

On the one hand, the social upheaval pushed the traditional right-wing parties to return to more centrist policies. It created an opportunity to strengthen programmatic identities and make them more progressive in terms of values and favorability to redistribution, pitching them as alternatives to the traditional defense of the dogmatic core of the right (at the confluence of neoliberalism and conservatism).

On the other hand, it also made space for a far-right contender. In the 2021 presidential elections, none of the center-right candidates made it to the runoff ballot. To the surprise of many, José Antonio Kast, the candidate of the radical-right *Partido Republicano* (PLR), far outperformed the center-right coalition, going on to compete with the candidate of the left, Gabriel Boric, in the second round. Furthermore, the coalition almost unconditionally endorsed Kast in the runoff. We argue that the irruption of the radical right implies a turning point in the dynamics of adaptation and renewal of the mainstream right, since the emergence of the PLR is a real threat to its traditional electoral base.

This chapter addresses the two logics of moderation – the *gattopardista* strategy and the ideational change – by analyzing the adaptation of the center-right coalition *Chile Vamos* to the challenges of a changing environment (Katz and Mair, 1995). The first part of this chapter argues that, in a context of transformation, changes in the “dominant coalition” (Panebianco et al., 1988) of the party that was most staunchly defensive of the status quo, the UDI, led it to follow the path of programmatic moderation. The “vote

¹ The concept originates from the book *Il Gattopardo*, by Giuseppe Tomasi di Lampedusa. *Gattopardismo* is best illustrated when one of the main characters cynically tells another that “if he wants things to stay the same, they will have to change” (di Lampedusa, 1960, 31).

² The social unrest refers to a series of massive protests and riots that originated in Santiago in October 2019, and then spread throughout the country.

³ A coalition comprising three political parties: the *Unión Demócrata Independiente* (UDI), founded in 1983, which is conservative and lent civil support to the military regime; *Renovación Nacional* (RN), created in 1987, whose left wing sought to promote a dialogue with the military government to facilitate the return to democracy (Pollack, 1999); and *Evolución Política* (*Evópoli*), founded in 2015, which expanded the coalition's boundaries on value issues.

maximizers," or pragmatics (Harmel and Janda, 1994), ended up prevailing over the "ideology advocates" or doctrinaires, and successfully expanded the UDI's territorial and electoral base. However, the renovating impetus of Piñera's first government led to a tension between the two positions. At the same time, the renewal of the coalition was reflected in the emergence of a new cultural and economic liberal referent – *Evópoli* – under Piñera's de facto leadership of the coalition, and the consolidation of a Christian socialist sensibility, mainly in RN.⁴

The second part of this chapter looks at the *gattopardista* strategy that characterized the coalition until Piñera's second term. It draws on the methodology of the Manifesto Research on Political Representation (MARPOR) project to analyze the evolutions over time of the programmatic proposals of the right-wing coalition, and the Parliamentary Elites of Latin America (PELA) survey. We show that the process of programmatic moderation up to 2017 was not correlated with a change in the attitudes of parliamentary elites, which proves the ability of the center-right coalition to adapt strategically, not only to the challenges of a changing environment but also to the characteristics of the leftist governments it succeeded and preceded and had to compete against.

The third part of this chapter turns to the question of the ideological renewal of the right, considering the effects of the 2019 social mobilization and the consolidation of a new left. We identify two effects. On the one hand, there was the strengthening of center-right forces more favorable to greater state involvement in the provision of social welfare. On the other hand, social unrest led to the rise of the far-right. This section concludes by outlining the existence of two different rights, which stemmed from the ideational repositioning of the coalition over the course of the debates of the Constitutional Convention. This analysis uses the Tresquintos database (Bunker et al., 2022), which details all the votes taken in the plenary sessions of the assembly between July 4, 2021 and July 4, 2022.

THE WINDING ROAD TOWARD MODERATION

Ideology Advocates versus Vote Maximizers

After an early attempt to build a "more liberal and progressive" right during the authoritarian period (Allamand, 1999), the idea of an opening toward the center reappeared in the discourse of Joaquín Lavín during the 1999 presidential election. On that occasion, the *Concertación*⁵ chose a socialist candidate – the

⁴ A concept coined by RN Senator Manuel José Ossandón in 2013 that emphasizes the promotion of social rights, a "solidarity state" and a "more humane" economic system. It seeks to differentiate itself from the traditional economic right. See María José Ahumada, "La derecha social, según Ossandón," *La Tercera*, July 14, 2018.

⁵ The coalition of center-left political parties founded in 1988, which won every election from the end of the dictatorship until 2010.

first to compete since Salazar. This nomination, which the left, gave the right a hegemony.

Though narrowly defeated, this was a turning point, converting the coalition into a revealed conflicting concept. It revealed the redefinition of its "main" as the redefinition of one's "national" transformation, "invariant coalition" (Panbiani, 2019). It distributes material and symbolic status, or social bonds.

Since the 1980s, and especially after the 1990s, for control over the right: advocates or "doctrinaires." Their electoral representation were moral conservatives and the dictatorship whose main political agenda. Although it shook the structural foundations of the debate between return to democracy, the strategists gained the upper hand. This can be explained by strategic resources that allowed them to maintain a dominant position (Joignant and Navia, 2003).

However, this did not mean exercising influence over the state without necessarily reaching the state. The right succeeded in maintaining a "protected" democratic model during the dictatorship (2009). Until coming to power, the right merely adapted to the incumbent *Concertación* model designed during the 1980s. *Concertación*'s reforms did not mean a return to neoliberal orthodoxy, but rather a focus on social policy issues.

On the use of the notion of political rights at this point, which partially contradicts the conservative party-building, see Gab

first to compete since Salvador Allende – as its candidate for the presidency. This nomination, which discouraged moderate and centrist voters among the left, gave the right a possibility to challenge the *Concertación*'s electoral hegemony.

Though narrowly defeated by Ricardo Lagos, Lavín's candidacy marked a turning point, converting the right into a potential majority. Lavín's success revealed conflicting conceptions of the coalition's ideological repositioning and its redefinition of its "main objective." According to Harmel and Janda (1994), the redefinition of one's "main objective" is key for understanding party organizational transformation, especially when it produces changes in the "dominant coalition" (Panebianco et al., 1988), the nucleus that concentrates and distributes material and symbolic incentives, such as recognition, honorary status, or social bonds.

Since the 1980s, and especially within the *UDI*, two camps have fought for control over the right: vote maximizers or "pragmatics" and ideological advocates or "doctrinaires." Vote maximizers pursued a strategy to increase their electoral representation and control the executive, while doctrinaires were moral conservatives and guardians of the economic model forged under the dictatorship whose main objective was to maintain influence over the political agenda. Although Joaquín Lavín's presidential candidacy did not shake the structural foundations of neoliberalism (de Zárata, 2016), it reanimated the debate between the two groups.⁶ In the first decades after the return to democracy, the strategy of moderation prevailed as the vote maximizers gained the upper hand, delivering significant electoral gains to the right. This can be explained by the mobilization of new organizational and strategic resources that allowed the *UDI* to expand its territorial footprint (Joignant and Navia, 2003).⁷

However, this did not alter a logic of action fundamentally based on exercising influence over the political agenda (Gibson, 1992: 7, 1996: 15) without necessarily reaching control of the Executive, nor seeking that control: The right succeeded in consolidating its own societal project based on a "protected" democracy model and a socioeconomic system established during the dictatorial period (Joignant and Navia, 2003; Siavelis, 2009). Until coming to power with Sebastián Piñera's presidency in 2010, the right merely adapted to new political circumstances and negotiated with the incumbent *Concertación*, which had perfected the socioeconomic model designed during the military regime. Apparently, the fact that the *Concertación*'s reforms did not fundamentally alter the structural commitment to neoliberal orthodoxy facilitated the shift of the Chilean right to the center on social policy issues.

⁶ On the use of the notion of political sensibilities, see Alenda, Le Foulon, and Suárez-Cao (2020).

⁷ On this point, which partially contradicts the ASP (authoritarian successor parties) theory on conservative party-building, see Gabriel Vommaro's chapter on the PRO in this volume.

The 2006 “penguin revolution”⁸ constituted the first shock against the neo-liberal model, but it was the exceptional intensity of the student mobilizations of 2011 that forced the Piñera government to deviate from its right-wing agenda.

The “Liberal” Right and Social Unrest

In 2010, Piñera became the first president from the right to be democratically elected since 1958.⁹ Overcoming the left-right cleavage, he coined the expression “new right” to refer to a conservative sensibility which embraced postmaterial concerns (Inglehart, 2015), such as human and indigenous rights, the environment, or social justice.¹⁰ Advisors to the President also made attempts to theorize a shift in orientation, with suggestions to abandon “the traditional, doctrinaire positions of the economically liberal, conservative values of the Pinochet right with a corporatist vision of society” (Izquierdo, 2010). The construction of a foundational and moderate “new right” was, however, frustrated by disagreements that surfaced within the coalition. These involved core issues, like how to deal with the Pinochet legacy as a government. While commemorating the fortieth anniversary of the coup, for instance, Piñera referred to the dictatorship’s “passive accomplices,”¹¹ a blow to the hearts of civilians included in the military government. In September 2013, he decided to close the Cordillera Penitentiary, where ex-military officers convicted of crimes against humanity were living in relative comfort. A second point of tension with the coalition’s hardline sector was the “values agenda,” on which the bill to legalize same-sex civil unions marked a push for change.

Piñera’s second term (2018–2022) mixed technocratic management and efficiency with an expansion of center-left social policies, earning it the nickname of the “fifth government of the Concertación.” Measures like raising taxes on businesses to finance repairs of the damages caused by the 2010 earthquake were highly criticized by the most orthodox sectors of the governing coalition.¹² They helped sharpen the sense of lack of a defined government identity beyond

⁸ The “Penguin Revolution” was the first substantial mobilization of secondary-school students in favor of the right to education and in response to the privatization of the educational system imposed by Augusto Pinochet’s dictatorship.

⁹ Sebastián Piñera, “Estamos construyendo una nueva derecha,” *El País*, November 7, 2010.

¹⁰ Rodrigo Hinzpeter, “Sus definiciones y la nueva derecha,” *Capital*, No. 288, November 9–16, 2010.

¹¹ Francisco Torrealba y Guillermo Turner, “Presidente Sebastián Piñera y su juicio a 40 años del golpe: ‘Hubo muchos que fueron cómplices pasivos: que sabían y no hicieron nada o no quisieron saber,’” *La Tercera*, August 31, 2013.

¹² Manuel Délano, “Piñera recurre a una subida temporal de impuestos para reconstruir Chile,” *El País*, May 06, 2010.

Between Gattopardism

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THE GAP BETWEEN PRO
AND THE PARLIAMENT.

The Ideological Positioning

This section analyzes the
parties of the Chilean right
(MARPOR). We understand

¹³ “Longueira: El Presidente Piñera
April 11, 2011.

¹⁴ Social unrest or malaise, in Sp
“bienestar social,” the conditio
Estado de bienestar).

¹⁵ See in particular Atria (2013).

¹⁶ A model that advocates for the s
port of private or community ac

good management.¹³ Even its unprecedented tax reform of 2012 (Fairfield and Garay, 2017) can be understood more as a reaction to the student mobilizations of 2011 than as part of a socially proactive presidential agenda.

The massive mobilizations of 2011 helped reactivate an ideological debate. Since the “Penguin Revolution” of 2006, the challenges to the bases of the socioeconomic model had intensified, and were leading to a feeling of *malestar social* (social unrest)¹⁴ in public opinion. While the political right was aware of these changes, it failed to recognize them as consequences of the neoliberal model of development.

From 2011 onward, intellectuals who questioned “neoliberal hegemony” began to make themselves known – the same ones who would later guide the reforms of the second Bachelet government (2014–2018).¹⁵ This accelerated the pace of ideological renovation on the right, where a sensibility of communitarian inspiration critical of the subsidiary model¹⁶ began to take shape, particularly in *Renovación Nacional* that ascribed to the principles of Christian socialism movements in 2014. This sensibility attracted supporters to the right after the 2019 social unrest. In addition, under the wing of *Piñerismo*, the political movement *Evópoli* emerged in 2012 with a clearly liberal agenda, marking a generational break within the coalition. This phenomenon follows the pattern of the renewal strategies of the post-2000 political right in the region, as pointed out in the introduction of this volume.

Before analyzing the strengthening of what we have called a sensibility of “solidarity” (Alenda et al., 2020b) after the social unrest, the following section examines the evolution of *Chile Vamos*’ programmatic moderation, contrasting it with the positions of the coalition’s parliamentary elites on public policy issues.

THE GAP BETWEEN PROGRAMMATIC MODERATION AND THE PARLIAMENTARY ELITE’S POSITIONS

The Ideological Positioning of Presidential Candidates

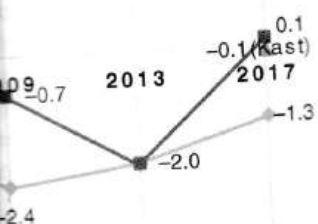
This section analyzes the changes and continuities in the ideologies of the parties of the Chilean right using the methodology of the Manifestos Project (MARPOR). We understand “party ideology” as the position that a party

¹³ “Longueira: El Presidente Piñera y el Gobierno no tienen un relato político,” *Cooperativa.cl*, April 11, 2011.

¹⁴ Social unrest or malaise, in Spanish “*malestar social*” also stands as the literal opposite of “*bienestar social*,” the condition of social welfare discursively linked to the welfare state (*el Estado de bienestar*).

¹⁵ See in particular Atria (2013).

¹⁶ A model that advocates for the state’s participation in the economy to be subsidiary or in support of private or community activities. It has its origin in the 1980 Constitution.



Vamos

presidential candidates' manifestos,

(2020) and Lowe et al. (2011).

cy (Gabel and Huber, 2000; on different issues (e.g., social – understood as the frequency of social programs (Laver, 2003). parties' programs on a left–right ideological positioning was constructed from twenty-six the left and right, respectively

al candidates' positions on the are modified using the logarithm (2011).¹⁷ Since data for the 2017 elections at 2017. The graph shows on the left–right axis (between the center (Gamboa et al., 2013; Ivira Kaltwasser, 2020). the left and right suggests grow– confirming that the governmental

age of a program dedicated to the the length of the program. Transforming we et al., 2011) considers the quantity of is when one does not have the original case for Lavín 2005, for which we used as a proxy.

programs of the right between 1989 and 2013 followed a strategy of vote maximization. This shift is also consistent with Downs' argument that “parties formulate policies in order to win elections, rather than win elections to formulate policies” (1957, 28). While the strategy of moving toward the center finally proved effective with Piñera's election in 2009, the evidence also shows that it was short lived, as by 2017 *Chile Vamos* had already returned to a position further to the right.

Figure 8.1 also shows that 1999 was a turning point relative to the two preceding elections, with Lavín's candidacy repositioning the UDI as a party that sought majority support. A major move to the left (–3.9) is observable with Lavín's 2005 program. Confronting the growing popularity of then-Minister of Defense Bachelet, Lavín moved his own positions on social issues to the left, “seeking a new deal in terms of labor relations, expanding collective bargaining,” and “favoring a solid and pluralist trade union movement.”¹⁸ Like the center–left, he emphasized the struggle against the inequality reflected “in an extremely wide income gap.”¹⁹ It may be inferred that increasing such mentions relative to his 1999 program allowed him to differentiate himself from Piñera and marked an attempt to attract centrist voters.

In 2013, the second major moderation of the right during this period took place when Evelyn Matthei (UDI) moved two points toward the center in the context of one of the right's most politically challenging presidential campaigns since the return to democracy. Three of its program's most salient themes were “Expanding Education” (15.65), “Expanding the Welfare State” (14.28), and “Market Regulation” (9.31). These three categories, which comprised nearly 40 percent of the manifesto, are on the left dimension of the RILE index. Considering Matthei's low odds of defeating Bachelet, one can surmise that she sought to maximize her votes by moving even further to the left than the median voter in order to be more competitive against Bachelet, who was ultimately elected that year.

Breaking with the trend initiated in 1999, Piñera's candidacy in 2017 took a turn to the right. While positioned very close to the political center (0.1 points) and less to the right than Büchi's program in 1989 or Alessandri's program in 1993, Piñera's program in 2017 was nonetheless to the right of that of any other candidate over the previous two decades.²⁰ This shift was attributable to the strong questioning of the structural reforms and economic results of the incumbent Bachelet government (Olivares and Varas, 2020).

MARPOR provides an economic index that considers whether one favors an economy that takes cues more from the market (MARKECO) or from the

¹⁸ Chile hacia el bicentenario: nuestra propuesta, p. 18.

¹⁹ Chile hacia el bicentenario: nuestra propuesta, p. 5.

²⁰ Most candidates in the 2017 elections positioned themselves to the left: Beatriz Sánchez (–1, 57), Marco Enriquez-Ominami (–1, 43), Carolina Goic (–1, 51), Alejandro Guillier (–1, 27), and José Antonio Kast (–0, 08).

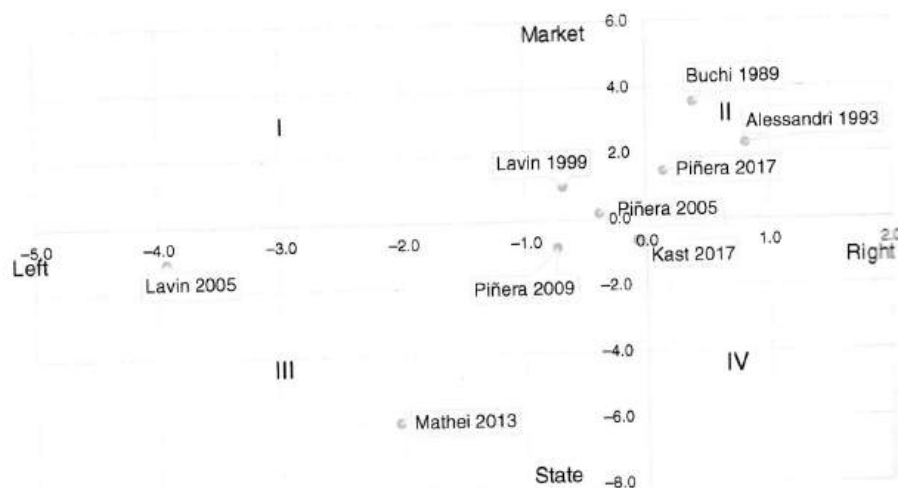


FIGURE 8.2 Left-right and economic placement of presidential candidates, 1989–2017. Source: Created by the authors based on Burst et al. (2020) and Lowe et al. (2011).

state (PLANECON). Figure 8.2 shows the spatial positioning of candidates along the left-right and market-state axes. It is clear that Büchi and Alessandri had the two programs located farthest to the right and were also the most fervent defenders of the market economy. One would expect all candidates to be located in the second quadrant (II), which covers the intersection between the defense of the free market and positioning on the right. However, that is not true in this case. Half the candidates are outside the second quadrant. The third quadrant (III) represents the classic spatial positioning of the left in general: In favor of greater state intervention in the economy and progressive political positions.

Most candidates were located very much in the center of the political (between +1 and -1) and economic axes (between +2 and -2). The cases of Lavin in 2005 and Matthei in 2013 are especially noteworthy. The former positioned himself more to the center on the economic axis, linking solutions to the inequality of opportunity to a “careful state intervention to promote the most disadvantaged,”²¹ but opposing a change in the extant economic model. However, thanks to his emphasis on the “expansion of education, market regulation, expansion of the welfare state, and labor groups,” he appeared closer to the left in political terms (close to -4). The case of Matthei was the reverse. She stayed in the center politically, but significantly distanced herself from the free market, reclaiming the role of the state in various areas: the protection of the rights of consumers, investors, and small businesses; early education;

²¹ Chile hacia el bicentenario: nuestra propuesta, p. 6.

subsidies for education and organizing trade union leaders.

Figures 8.1 and 8.2 show Piñera’s programs compared to 1999 in the case of Lavin. However, this was reversed: the center-right approached the left, presented themselves as beneficiaries of free competition. On the left, they are similar if the margin of error is taken into account. Kast’s program did allude to services like education,²² which was a positioning.

Programs are an appropriate tool for candidates on matters of economic conditions of electoral competition and above all, citizens’ public services. To verify whether this movement in the positions of party elites, legislative representatives on socioeconomic redistribution.

Ideological Positioning of the

Legislators’ political positioning. The analysis of the political positioning of the Parliamentarians Latinoamericana, Salamanca, which (at this point) for Chile. Figure 8.3 shows the positioning of the RN on the left-right axis and in contrast to the analysis of the deputies of the right was quite different. The confidence intervals overlap, with the legislators’ perceptions appear to be different from 2002 to 2017. The evidence

²² José Antonio Kast Rist, Un programa

²³ The scales go from 1 to 10, with 5 being the center. The analysis of the political positioning of the Parliamentarians Latinoamericana, Salamanca, which (at this point) for Chile. Figure 8.3 shows the positioning of the RN on the left-right axis and in contrast to the analysis of the deputies of the right was quite different. The confidence intervals overlap, with the legislators’ perceptions appear to be different from 2002 to 2017. The evidence

²⁴ It is not possible to compare Figures 8.1 and 8.2 because they do not cover the same time period and are not useful for determining general trends.



Presidential candidates, 1989–2017. (2010) and Lowe et al. (2011).

ial positioning of candidates clear that Büchi and Alessandri right and were also the most would expect all candidates to covers the intersection between g on the right. However, that outside the second quadrant. spatial positioning of the left in the economy and progressive

in the center of the political (ween +2 and -2). The cases of ially noteworthy. The former economic axis, linking solutions ate intervention to promote the in the extant economic model. nsion of education, market reg- por groups," he appeared closer case of Matthei was the reverse. antly distanced herself from the n various areas: the protection all businesses; early education;

subsidies for education and employment; and state financing for professionalizing trade union leaders.

Figures 8.1 and 8.2 show a tendency toward moderation in Lavín and Piñera's programs compared to their first and second campaigns (2005 versus 1999 in the case of Lavín, and 2009 versus 2005 in the case of Piñera). However, this was reversed in 2017, to the point that the position of the center-right approached that of the radical right. Both centrists and radicals presented themselves as being opposed to regulations that would restrict free competition. On the left-right axis, the positions of Piñera and Kast are similar if the margin of error involved in these estimations is considered. Kast's program did allude briefly to the role of the state in financing public services like education,²² which could help explain his slightly more moderate positioning.

Programs are an appropriate source for studying the positions of presidential candidates on matters of public policy. However, they depend heavily on the conditions of electoral competition, the positions of other political actors, and above all, citizens' public policy priorities (Spoon and Klüver, 2014). To verify whether this movement toward the center in manifestos correlated with the positions of party elites, the next section analyzes the positions of parliamentary representatives on an array of issues, especially those concerning socioeconomic redistribution.

Ideological Positioning of the Right's Parliamentary Elites

Legislators' political positions were analyzed using data from the Elites Parlamentarias Latinoamericanas (PELA) project of the University of Salamanca, which (at this point in time) covers just six legislatures (1993–2017) for Chile. Figure 8.3 shows the averages for the deputies of the UDI and RN on the left-right axis and on market regulation versus market freedom.²³ In contrast to the analysis of presidential candidates, the self-location of the deputies of the right was quite stable throughout this period.²⁴ Given that the confidence intervals overlap, with the exception of the UDI in 1993–2018, legislators' perceptions appear to have been similar across parties and over time from 2002 to 2017. The evidence shows the deputies of the UDI to be farther

²² José Antonio Kast Rist, *Un programa para volver a crecer*, p. 21.

²³ The scales go from 1 to 10, with 5 as the midpoint. On the market axis, 1 signifies maximum state regulation of the economy, and 10 signifies maximum market freedom. On the left-right axis, representatives were asked about their party's position on a scale of 1 to 10, with 1 being most on the left and 10 being most on the right. The 1997–2001 legislature was not included because representatives were not asked about their position on the state-market axis.

²⁴ It is not possible to compare Figures 8.2 and 8.3 numerically, as they neither measure the same thing nor cover the same time periods, while also using different scales. However, they are useful for determining general tendencies.

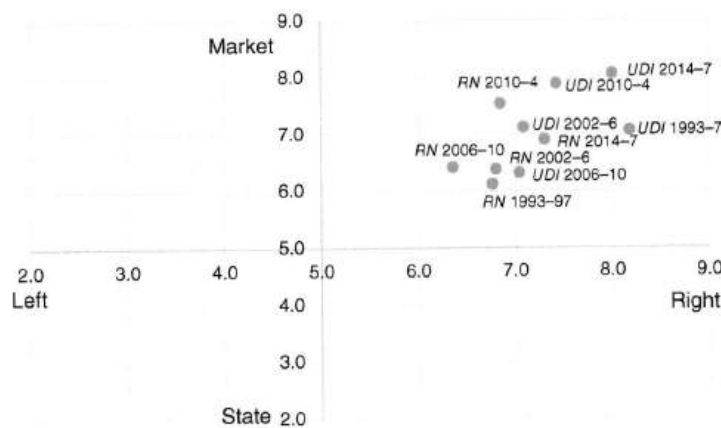


FIGURE 8.3 Left-right and economic placement of congressmen, 1993–2017.
Source: Created by the authors based on Alcántara (2021).

to the right (7.5) than those of RN (6.8), but without any significant difference in their pro-market position.

The legislators' stable pro-market position did not necessarily imply a refusal to recognize the social value of the state.²⁵ In Figure 8.4, one can see their degree of agreement (from 1 = strongly disagree to 7 = strongly agree) with the state's role in providing social welfare. A pro-market position is notable in the opposition of UDI and RN deputies to state ownership of the country's main businesses. There is, however, moderate recognition of the state's role in social welfare provision, reducing income inequality, and pensions, without significant differences from one party or time period to another in this regard. The subject of pensions is particularly noteworthy. In this period, both parties defended the system of private pensions in effect since 1982, only showing openness to a state-administered pension system after the social mobilizations of 2019 (Ahumada, 2019).

When comparing the issue positions of the parties according to MARPOR and PELA data, we find a gap between the moderation of the coalition's programs – a trend that was reversed in 2017 due to the perception that Michelle Bachelet had shifted to the left in her second government – and the attachment of a majority of its elites to a subsidiary model of the state. This relative ideological rigidity empirically supports the thesis of *gattopardismo*. However, since 2019, a multidimensional crisis and a new political juncture intensified the ideational change within the ruling and party elites of the right.

²⁵ This persistent defense of the economic model is confirmed by a survey applied in 2015–2017 to the party elites of the UDI, RN, and *Evópoli*, the results of which showed that 69 percent favored the free market, whether from a more classic neoliberal perspective or one favoring a subsidiary role for the state (Alenda et al., 2020).

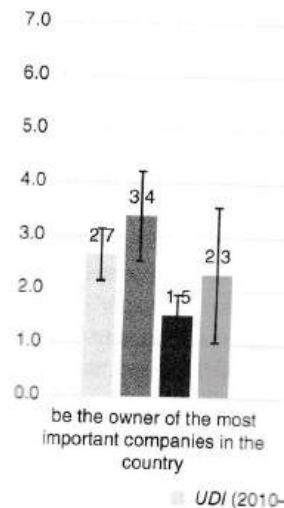


FIGURE 8.4 Legislators' position on state ownership of the country's main businesses (2010–2018).

Source: Created by the authors based on Alcántara (2021).

THE DOUBLE IMPACT

The Effects of a Multidimensional

As seen in the previous chapter, the economic change in direction with the 2010–2018 coalition was characterized by structural changes pushed by a second transition toward a more open economy (ECLAC, 2018) thanks to the 2010–2018 coalition. But at the end of the 2010–2018 coalition, growth decreased, and consumption fell (ECLAC, 2019), sowing the seeds of a new crisis. Growth fell to 0.8 percent in 2019.

As mentioned previously, the debate on a “paradigm change” in the political world who had contributed to the project (Atria, 2014). A f

²⁶ Programa de gobierno 2018–2020 (2017).

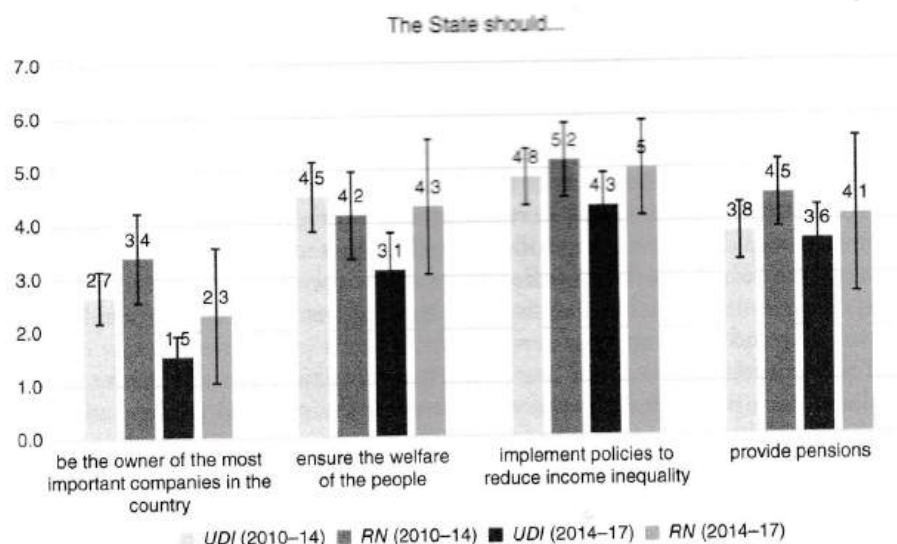


FIGURE 8.4 Legislators' perceptions concerning the role of the state in the economy (2010-2018).

Source: Created by the authors based on Alcántara (2021).

THE DOUBLE IMPACT OF THE SOCIAL UNREST

The Effects of a Multidimensional Crisis

As seen in the previous section, the second Piñera administration marked a change in direction with respect to the programmatic moderation that had characterized the coalition until then. A counterreform sought to reverse the structural changes pushed by the Bachelet government as a means to "initiate a second transition toward integral development."²⁶ In 2018, the economy more than doubled its rate of growth when compared to the preceding year (ECLAC, 2018) thanks to the reduction of taxes on large companies (Rivera, 2018). But at the end of the year, the price of copper began to fall, exports decreased, and consumption and investment contracted drastically (ECLAC, 2019), sowing the seeds of the social unrest. At the end of 2019, the rate of growth fell to 0.8 percent (ECLAC, December 2019).

As mentioned previously, from 2011 onward, there was an increasing debate on a "paradigm change," led by actors from the intellectual and political world who had contributed to the Bachelet government's "refoundational" project (Atria, 2014). A few years later, the social uprising and the massive

²⁶ Programa de gobierno 2018-2022. *Construyamos tiempos mejores para Chile* (October 30, 2017).

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on the right. Ideologically,
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ning of certain ideological

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ric "Agreement for Social
15, 2019, thus paving the
those democratic legitimacy
empowered to draft a new
plebiscite for approval. This
s, accentuated differences
of members, as shown ear-
for the state.

portunity for consolidating a
on features extending across
Constitution and the consol-
aring social welfare. It gave
pen to considering the possi-
age the conflict (Alenda et al.,
local level, such as the mayor
their support for changing the
own parties.²⁷ *Evópoli*, which
the Bachelet government, was
s to line up in support of the
new Constitution should be
nbers free to vote as they saw
ard approval, including then-
figure of the Christian socialist
percent of those who identified
in the 2020 plebiscite.²⁸

árez-Cao (2020), 79 percent of UDI
s to be opposed to establishing a new

third of those who considered them-
Sajuria, 2020).

Although *Renovación Nacional* had already been moving closer to a Christian socialist orientation since 2014, this tendency gained momentum with the social unrest. The COVID-19 crisis that immediately followed also reinvigorated the role of the state through the adoption of multi-billion-dollar aid packages, allowing those Christian socialist political and intellectual elites to undertake an offensive against the economic model inherited from the Chicago Boys.²⁹ In the presidential primaries of July 2021, four center-right candidates competed, including Mario Desbordes.

However, the multidimensional crisis, which deepened with the pandemic, also opened up a window of opportunity for consolidating a radical right, which was represented by the PLR. After the November agreement,³⁰ its leader sought to speak more strongly in the name of the right's traditional identity, lambasting the "faltering" character of a political agenda that had established a plebiscite to determine whether the Constitution would be changed (a process that, in the end, would be rubber-stamped by 78.2 percent of the people).

Finally, the crisis readjusted the ideological convictions of the governing elite. The delay and the insufficiency of governmental assistance in the first stage of the pandemic led various actors on the political right – mayors, party leaders, and parliamentary representatives – to develop various strategies to deal with the crisis that challenged the hegemonic subsidiary conception of the state's role. Under pressure, the government first switched to targeted credit policies, which gave the impression of favoring businesses at the expense of the population,³¹ and then to universal policies such as temporary monthly payments to all but the highest-earning 10 percent of households, which was announced in August 2021. It then instituted a new public subsidy for improving pensions, which was approved in January 2022 (Alenda et al., 2022). These new public policy measures marked a significant departure from the subsidiary model inherited from neoliberalism, embracing universality and guaranteeing rights. This shift in the social policy paradigm signaled an ideational change among the governing elites of the Chilean right.

In the first stage of the crisis, the right's resounding defeat in the May 15–16, 2021 elections for members of the constitutional assembly, municipal officeholders and regional governors in part reflected citizen disaffection toward a governing coalition that was considered to be overly obsessed with macroeconomics. In the election of constitutional constituents, the right did not reach the desired quorum of one third (33 percent +1), which would have allowed it to veto any article to which it objected. With 21 percent of the vote

²⁹ On the construction of this project, see Rumié, Alenda, and Fernández (2020).

³⁰ The November agreement was a document signed by most major political parties in which they agreed to initiate a constitutional process. It was signed on November 15, 2019 under the title "Agreement for Social Peace and the New Constitution."

³¹ By increasing the capital of the Guarantee Fund for Small Businessmen (FOGAPE), initially created in 1980.

and just thirty-seven constituents (23.9 percent), the election left the right as a practically irrelevant actor in the process. This crushing defeat was only partly attributable to the singularity of the election, as the right fared poorly in local and regional contests as well. It can therefore be read as a punishment of the Piñera administration. With the defeat in the rearview mirror, the parties of *Chile Vamos* reorganized, looking forward to the general elections in November 2021. For the first time, each of the three parties presented their own candidate in the July 18 primaries, where they were joined by independent Sebastián Sichel, a former Christian Democrat who had up to then served in the second Piñera administration as the Minister of Social Development and Family.

Both the coalition parties' and Sichel's programs highlighted the same two progressive features: Supporting the approval of a new constitutional process in the 2020 plebiscite and favoring the consolidation of a state that would be more active in ensuring social welfare. Lavín, in addition to advocating for "social integration" to make Chileans' life conditions more equal, emphasized the beginning of a "new cycle" in Chilean politics. Faithful to the programmatic promise associated with *Evópoli* since its foundation, Ignacio Briones – the second Minister of Finance of the second Piñera government – included an agenda aimed at social justice in his program (Alenda, 2020). He defended the need to strengthen the state's role in delivering public goods. Desbordes stressed his "profound social vocation" and the "communitarian" character of "popular Republicanism," which served as the theoretical anchor of his proposal. Finally, Sichel competed with a liberal, centrist program, with a focus on entrepreneurship, sustainability (another theme shared by the four candidates), and an inclusive society.

The public policies included in their programs attest to the impact that social mobilization and the plebiscite had on the parties of the center-right. While granting importance to the traditional policies of the right, like economic growth, they still paid more attention to social reform and the idea of "generating mechanisms to allow for sharing the gains of development" (Lavín, 2021, 5/6). The RN candidate in the primary, Mario Desbordes, distanced himself quite explicitly from the neoliberal vision, emphasizing the need for market regulation as a response to the problems of collusion that had recently affected the country. His program was particularly critical of "elites who have ended up enclosed in segregated neighborhoods, disconnecting themselves from the territories and from the popular situation, and making deracinated political decisions" (Desbordes, 2021).

The primary election focused more on personality traits than on notable programmatic differences among the candidates, all of whom shared the same social orientation, a more egalitarian political agenda that distanced itself from the neoliberal-mercantilist discourse of the 1980s–1990s. Sebastián Sichel won with 49.1 percent of the votes. Although he was initially supported by the other three nominees, his candidacy soon weakened. In contrast, the leader of

the radical right José Antonio Kast where he appealed mainly to the rule of law. These issues also became increasingly dominant in the Convention to improve the country.

Despite its moderate path, *Chile Vamos* also included a radical right. The UDI unconditional candidate belonged until 2016, with some adjustments in Kast's government. In the Constitutional Council, *Evópoli* also decided to participate in an eventual government, which they interpreted as support, which they interpreted as support. *Vamos*.³² The electoral pacts of the center-right went hand in hand with the strengthening of the role of the state in social policy. This new sensibility was manifested in the delegation at the Constitutional C

The Two Rights within the Const

This section analyzes the behavior of the right in the Constitutional Convention. It allows for identifying their relative support to roll-call voting analysis, a procedure for a legislative body (each legislator votes by voting for alternatives that are closest to their ideal points and the votes' results are used to adjust spatial models. See Poole, 2000; Clinton et al., 2004). Rosenthal (1985) has the advantage of being based on their votes along two dimensions (or progressive-conservative).

We fed the model using all roll-call votes in the Convention, as recorded by Bunker. On July 4, 2022, a total of 4,306 roll-call votes were taken in the primary session.³³ Figure 8.5 shows the results by alliances, along the two dimensions.

³² In "Catarsis en la derecha liberal: La fractura del apoyo a Kast," *The Clinic*, November 2021.

³³ While voting, each of the 155 constituents was counted as absent.

³⁴ These blocs or groups are informal alliances of like-minded members to maximize admin

t), the election left the right as This crushing defeat was only ction, as the right fared poorly erefore be read as a punishment n the rearview mirror, the par- ward to the general elections in he three parties presented their e they were joined by indepen- crat who had up to then served Minister of Social Development

grams highlighted the same two of a new constitutional process idation of a state that would be , in addition to advocating for ditions more equal, emphasized olitics. Faithful to the program- its foundation, Ignacio Briones d Piñera government – included m (Alenda, 2020). He defended vering public goods. Desbordes e “communitarian” character of e theoretical anchor of his pro- centrist program, with a focus on e shared by the four candidates),

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ersonality traits than on notable tes, all of whom shared the same agenda that distanced itself from 1980s–1990s. Sebastián Sichel he was initially supported by the akened. In contrast, the leader of

the radical right José Antonio Kast prospered in a context of great fluidity, where he appealed mainly to the themes of order, security, and reestablishing the rule of law. These issues assumed central importance in public opinion, which also became increasingly doubtful about the ability of the Constitutional Convention to improve the country’s situation (CEP survey, August 2021).

Despite its moderate path, *Chile Vamos* ended up backing the leader of the radical right. The UDI unconditionally supported Kast, a party to which the candidate belonged until 2016, while RN conditioned its support on substantial adjustments in Kast’s government program. After a debate at a national council, *Evópoli* also decided to support Kast, but rejected the idea of participating in an eventual government. Several liberal intellectuals criticized this support, which they interpreted as a new sign of a rightward shift in *Chile Vamos*.³² The electoral pacts of the center–right parties with the radical right went hand in hand with the strengthening of a more centrist sensibility in relation to the role of the state in society. As we will see in the following section, this new sensibility was manifested in the votes of a faction of the right-wing delegation at the Constitutional Convention.

The Two Rights within the Constitutional Convention

This section analyzes the behavior of the thirty-seven representatives of the right in the Constitutional Convention using a spatial model of voting that allows for identifying their relative ideological positioning. In its application to roll-call voting analysis, a premise of this examination is that each member of a legislative body (each legislator) seeks to maximize his or her utility by voting for alternatives that minimize the distance between his or her ideal points and the votes’ results (McFadden, 1973). There are various procedures to adjust spatial models of voting (Heckman and Snyder Jr., 1996; Poole, 2000; Clinton et al., 2004). The “wnominate” method of Poole and Rosenthal (1985) has the advantage of allowing for an ordering of legislators based on their votes along two dimensions: left–right and liberal–authoritarian (or progressive–conservative).

We fed the model using all roll-call votes taken during the Constitutional Convention, as recorded by Bunker et al. (2022). Between July 4, 2021 and July 4, 2022, a total of 4,306 roll-call votes were cast in the Convention’s plenary session.³³ Figure 8.5 shows the distribution of the constituents, clustered by alliances, along the two dimensions.³⁴ The horizontal axis orders these

³² In “Catarsis en la derecha liberal: La fractura entre Evópoli y los académicos de Horizontal por apoyo a Kast,” *The Clinic*, November 27, 2021.

³³ While voting, each of the 155 constituents could choose to vote “for” or “against,” abstain, or be counted as absent.

³⁴ These blocs or groups are informal alliances within coalitions. They formed strategically among like-minded members to maximize administrative benefits, such as floor time.

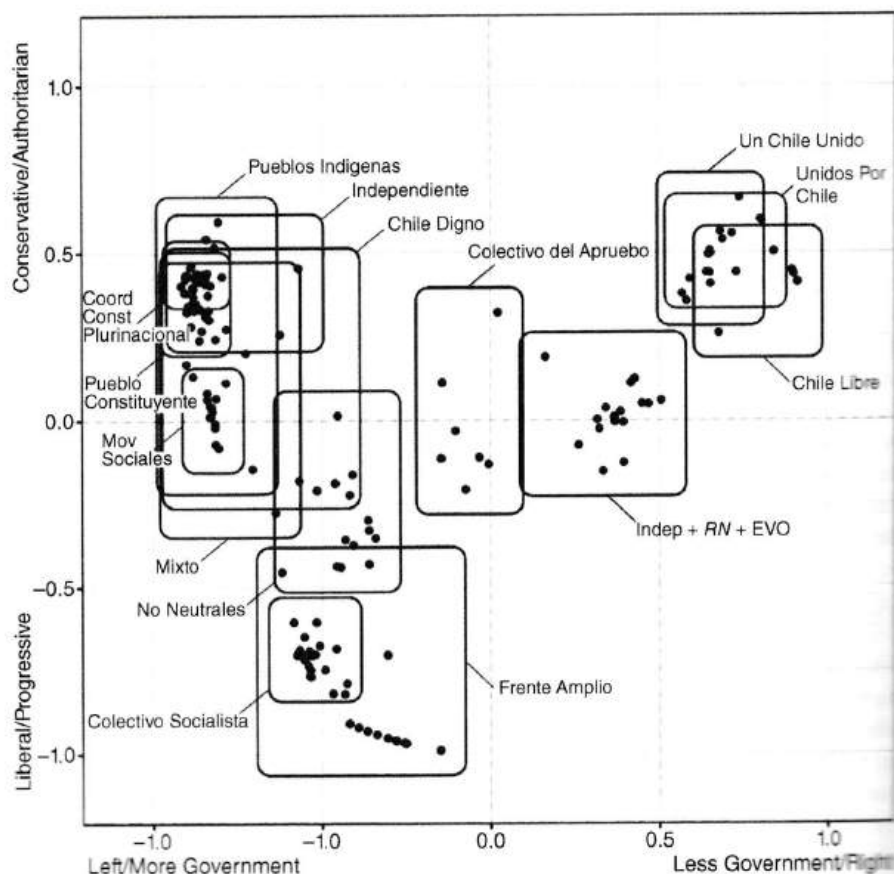


FIGURE 8.5 Distribution of blocs in the Constitutional Convention.

alliances on a scale running from very left (-1) to very right (+1). Consistent with that intuition, it shows that the four legislative factions (or blocs) of the right (Independientes, RN, and *Evópoli*; Chile Libre; Unidos por Chile; and Un Chile Unido) are located in the upper-right quadrant.

Figure 8.5 also suggests the existence of two rights. One comprised members of the *UDI*, RN, and PLR, while the other included members of *Evópoli*, RN, and independents (EVO+RN+IND). The latter had even more in common with the pro-new Constitution (option "Apruebo") bloc linked to the former Concertación than with other right blocs. Even if the bulk of the right is located in the (conservative) upper-right quadrant, a relevant portion of the EVO+RN+IND alliance is located in the (liberal) lower-right quadrant.

The evolution of the relative positioning of each constitutional constituent based on his or her successive votes proves that there was a gradual polarization in the Convention. Over time, most constituents moved toward the extreme

TABLE 8.1 Average ideological coalition and alliances

Coalition (number of members)
Alliance (number of members)

Vamos por Chile (37)
Chile Libre (6)
Unidos por Chile (8)
Un Chile Unido (7)
Indep + RN + Evo (16)
Apruebo Dignidad
Listas Independientes
Lista del Apruebo
No Neutrales
Native peoples (17 reserved seats)

Source: Created by the authors.

closest to their original location within the center-left.³⁵ Averaging of origin, starting with the third of the Convention's second session, the first six months in operation, one can observe that two of the blocs moved toward their original positions. One is the "Indep" group, and the other is "Indep + RN + EVO," which is the only group close to the center-left (including those that do not move) in ideological positions.

Finally, we created a correlation matrix of constituents using Wei and Sim's method. The symmetric reordering of vectors of constituents as vectors and the resulting combinations in order to find correlations, frequency, and to what degree the result of the correlation matrix (the larger square) represents the constituents. If the square is blue, the correlation is positive; if it is red, the correlation is negative. For example, a dark blue square represents a high positive correlation between a pair of constituents.

³⁵ Cristián Livingstone, "Quiénes son los votantes," *El Líbero*, April 3, 2010.

TABLE 8.1 Average ideological position of constitutional constituents by coalition and alliances

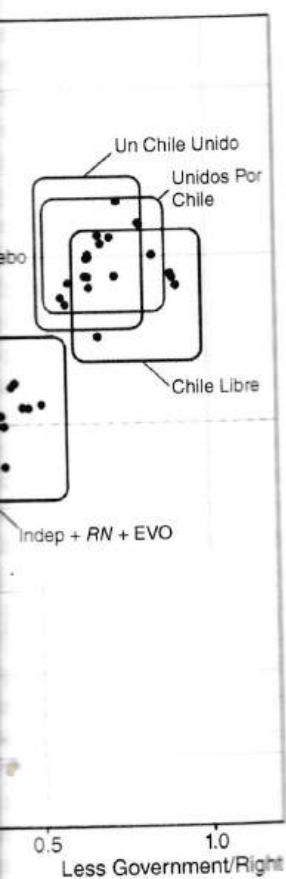
Coalition (number of members) Alliance (number of members)	Vote 1,000 (January 2022)	Vote 4,306 (July 2022)	Change
Vamos por Chile (37)	7.9	8.1	+0.2
Chile Libre (6)	9.2	9.2	0.0
Unidos por Chile (8)	8.5	8.8	+0.3
Un Chile Unido (7)	8.3	8.8	+0.5
Indep + RN + Evo (16)	6.9	6.9	0.0
Apruebo Dignidad	2.0	1.8	-0.2
Listas Independientes	0.8	0.8	0.0
Lista del Apruebo	3.7	3.3	-0.4
No Neutrales	3.0	2.8	-0.2
Native peoples (17 reserved seats)	0.8	0.9	+0.1

Source: Created by the authors.

closest to their original location. However, this tendency was most marked within the center-left.³⁵ Averaging constituents' individual scores by their bloc of origin, starting with the thousandth vote (which coincided with the election of the Convention's second set of internal leaders on January 5, 2022, after its first six months in operation) and ending with the last vote on May 14, 2022, one can observe that two of the right's alliances do not move rightward from their original positions. One is Chile Libre, the Convention's most extreme group, and the other is "Independientes, RN, y Evópoli." Notably, the latter is the only group close to the center that does not move. All the other blocs (including those that do not appear in Table 8.1) experienced a small change in ideological positions.

Finally, we created a correlation matrix among all possible pairs of constituents using Wei and Simko (2017) method, which allows for the automatic reordering of vectors to find latent patterns in the data. We used the constituents as vectors and crossed them against all possible binary combinations in order to find out who voted similarly to whom, with what frequency, and to what degree. Figure 8.6 in the online resources shows the result of the correlation matrix using all the votes. Each small square (within the larger square) represents the correlation between the two respective constituents. If the square is blue, the correlation is positive, and if the square is red, the correlation is negative; gray squares indicate no correlation. For example, a dark blue square indicates a high direct correlation between a pair of constituents.

³⁵ Cristián Livingstone, "Quiénes son los convencionales que más se han 'radicalizado' en sus votaciones," *El Líbero*, April 3, 2022.



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moved toward the extreme

The correlation matrix confirms this division within the right, showing the existence of a group that represents more moderate positions (the EVO+RN+IND alliance) that was more open to moving toward its counterparts in view of necessary reforms. This was reflected in the following declaration of one of the members of that group: "We do not believe in the trenches, or in extreme ideologies either. We want to join in this common objective, which is to forge ahead with drafting a new Constitution that lays the foundation for a new Chile."³⁶ In contrast, the other three alliances resisted change.

These results are relevant in the context of the current debate on the role of the right in the constitutional process. Some have suggested that it played an important role in drafting the text,³⁷ whereas others maintain that they resorted to the textbook of illiberal tricks: instilling fear, spreading misinformation, and demonizing the opposition.³⁸ This study finds evidence that the right was divided into two groups, which is reminiscent of the division between pragmatics and doctrinaires in that one group held fast to its ideological legacy, whereas the other showed greater flexibility. However, although we cannot discard the possibility that a certain pragmatism was involved in the more moderate right bloc's relative proximity to the progressive positions of its left-liberal counterparts, its votes also suggested an ideational change. A qualitative examination of these votes shows that there were various instances in which some of its groups (usually the independents, *Evópoli*, and RN) supported greater state regulation, and concepts commonly associated with the welfare state and a series of other progressive proposals. For example, RN constitutional constituents Cristián Monckeberg and Ruggero Cozzi showed themselves to be in favor of "housing as a right," which implies that the state should be responsible for guaranteeing that right.³⁹

Various declarations also supported this hypothesis of a change in ideas. For instance, in the middle of the constitutional reform process, constitutional constituent Marcela Cubillos, from the group "Un Chile Unido," declared that the Constitution written by Pinochet had de facto reached its end with the plebiscite of October 2020.⁴⁰ This was particularly noteworthy given that Cubillos was a former Piñera minister from the UDI, the party most in favor

³⁶ Felipe Reyes, "Vamos por Chile se sigue fragmentando: 16 convencionales de RN y *Evópoli* crean nuevo colectivo," *bbcl*, November 3, 2021.

³⁷ Claudio Fuentes, "Cuando la derecha cruza el cerco: análisis caso a caso de sus votaciones en la Convención," *Ciper*, April 6, 2022 and as a critique of this column, José Antonio Valenzuela, "Las cifras de Claudio Fuentes," *El Mostrador*, April 22, 2022.

³⁸ Jennifer Piscopo y Peter Siavelis, "How Chile's Constitutional Overhaul Emboldened the Right," *Foreign Policy*, May 23, 2022.

³⁹ Andrés Aguayo, "Esto piensan los constituyentes de Chile Vamos en siete áreas clave," *Punto*, May 23, 2021.

⁴⁰ Marcela Cubillos, "Nadie pretende volver atrás, la Constitución actual murió en el plebiscito pasado," *CNN Prime*, April 28, 2022.

of the status quo. Similarly, Senar that there was "a real will to cha

After the final text was han UDI, RN, and *Evópoli* sent a let continue with the process of con the Constitution proposed by t September 2022 plebiscite upon of Chileans (62 percent) did rej of being accused of "betraying d Javier Macaya, played a crucial a sister agreement to the Novem December 2022 by all major poli

CONCLUSION

This chapter analyzed the winding in Chile since the late 1990s: (1) ond candidacy of Sebastián Piñera after the social unrest. The *gattop between programmatic moderation logical rigidity. Ideational change tive programmatic identities in the of new postmaterial and generatio*

The peculiarity of the Chilean c not only occurred on the cultural of redistribution. This also inclu that allowed parties such as the U these new programmatic identities and cultural changes that have oc These transformations fostered cor identities of mass electorates, crea political right, as shown in the intr

The recasting of the mainstream of *Chile Vamos*, not only to the ch to the characteristics of the leftist g Ricardo Lagos' deepening of the Boric's "refoundational" left (Dab of the neoliberal model were not e ment to move toward the center. Bu

⁴¹ Javier Macaya: "Con justa razón no n Tenemos que dar muestras de confianza,

⁴² Video "Traidor de la UDI": El "apriete Eldesconcierto.cl, September 25, 2022.

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of the status quo. Similarly, Senator and *UDI* President Javier Macaya deemed that there was "a real will to change" in *Chile Vamos*.⁴¹

After the final text was handed in on May 14, 2022, the presidents of *UDI*, *RN*, and *Evópoli* sent a letter to President Boric expressing the need to continue with the process of constitutional reform even if the new version of the Constitution proposed by the Convention was rejected in the upcoming September 2022 plebiscite upon ratification. On September 4, a large majority of Chileans (62 percent) did reject the new constitutional proposal. In spite of being accused of "betraying the nation,"⁴² the then-president of the *UDI*, Javier Macaya, played a crucial role in promoting the *Acuerdo por Chile*, a sister agreement to the November 2019 one, which was finally signed in December 2022 by all major political parties, except the *PLR*.

CONCLUSION

This chapter analyzed the winding road to moderation of the mainstream right in Chile since the late 1990s: (1) what we called *gattopardismo* until the second candidacy of Sebastián Piñera and (2) an ideational change that intensified after the social unrest. The *gattopardista* strategy was shown through the gap between programmatic moderation and the parliamentary elites' relative ideological rigidity. Ideational change was observed in the development of distinctive programmatic identities in the post-2000 period, as well as the activation of new postmaterial and generational cleavages.

The peculiarity of the Chilean case lies in the fact that this renewal of ideas not only occurred on the cultural dimension but also in regards to the concept of redistribution. This also included a certain organizational strengthening that allowed parties such as the *UDI* to grow electorally. We also show that these new programmatic identities were inseparable from the socioeconomic and cultural changes that have occurred in Chile during the last thirty years. These transformations fostered concomitant shifts in the attitudes and political identities of mass electorates, creating opportunities for the renovation of the political right, as shown in the introduction to this volume.

The recasting of the mainstream right fundamentally implied an adaptation of *Chile Vamos*, not only to the challenges of a changing environment but also to the characteristics of the leftist governments it had to compete against, from Ricardo Lagos' deepening of the neoliberal model (Fazio, 2007), to Gabriel Boric's "refoundational" left (Dabène et al., 2023). As long as the foundations of the neoliberal model were not endangered, the mainstream right was content to move toward the center. But as soon as they became threatened, from

⁴¹ Javier Macaya: "Con justa razón no nos creen que queremos cambiar la Constitución ... Tenemos que dar muestras de confianza," *La Tercera*, May 22, 2022.

⁴² Video "Traidor de la UDI": El "apriete" del Team Patriota y Pancho malo a Javier Macaya, *Eldesconcierto.cl*, September 25, 2022.

the second Bachelet government onward, they reacted by moving toward more conservative positions.

While the initial moderation strategy, identified as *gattopardismo*, took place under conditions in which the median voter was moving away from conservative ideas, it would be premature to interpret the postconstitutional constituents' election of May 7, 2023 as the opposite. The victory of the *Partido Republicano* does not necessarily indicate a shift toward the radical right. Indeed, the crosscutting nature of the Republican vote does not seem to respond to general right-wing voting patterns,⁴³ but instead to a specific situation of citizenship weariness regarding the constitutional process, and dissatisfaction with a government considered incapable of providing solutions to social problems. The electoral result may also be associated with the fact that the *Partido Republicano* was better positioned than *Chile Vamos* on public security issues. The importance that these issues had on voting intentions makes the electoral support for Republicans more pragmatic than programmatic. However, even if this vote was less programmatic, it has opened the door for the strengthening of a disruptive right-wing ideological project in the long term.

⁴³ "UDD study: Kast swept the evangelical vote, the areas most affected by violence and irregular migration, and the left had less support in poor communities," *Ex-Ante*, May 8, 2023.

Whose Right, Whose Complexities of Right

Maryhen Jiménez

Rafael Caldera, Rómulo to distribute the cake at Venezuela, and now the says that it is ready to return never return, the Venezuela

INTRODUCTION

The pink tide in Latin America system broke down and Hugo presidential election in December abroad hoped that the anties leader would initiate reform for Venezuelans. Chávez pr transformative process and decades after his first election "revolution" instead eroded d humanitarian crises due to a mismanagement. Despite this Maduro continue to blame ongoing turmoil. Who truly make sense of political cleav

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